

KAPOW! Comic Book Editor — Design Handoff

Version: prototype v3 · July 19, 2026 · Reference implementation: *Kapow Comic Editor.dc.html*

1. Product overview

Kapow is a tablet-first browser app for making comics. The core audience is hobbyists and kids; the design optimizes for large touch targets (44px+), a playful hand-built aesthetic, and maximum canvas space. All editing happens in one editor view driven by three **workflow modes** — Layout, Draw, Letter — with a contextual tool tray that swaps per mode.

Everything is local: sign-in is a lightweight identity (a name), and projects persist in browser storage. There is no server in the prototype.

2. App structure & navigation

Screen	Purpose	Exits
Sign in	Name entry; remembered across sessions (kapow.user).	→ Projects
Projects	Start a new comic in one of 4 formats (format cards with page-shape previews); open or delete saved projects.	→ Editor · → Sign in (sign out)
Editor	The comic workspace. Header: New, page-size menu, +Page/ ↓ Longer, undo/redo, theme, Save, Save As..., Export, Sign out. Footer: mode tabs + contextual tray.	→ Projects (logo or  New; auto-saves) · → Sign in

New projects start blank — no default panels. An empty-state hint points to the panel tools.

3. Page formats, pages & presets

Each format has its own layout presets. Applying a preset replaces panels on the *newest* page only.

Format	Canvas (units)	Presets	Multi-page model
Comic (6.625×10.25")	620 × 956	3 Rows · 2×2 · 2×3 · Big + 2	+Page appends a labeled page below (44-unit gutter). Each page has a 🗑 delete button; content below shifts up.
Manga B5 (176×250 mm)	560 × 794	4-koma · 2×2 · Action (slanted rows) · Big + 2	
Newspaper strip	1000 × 330	3 across · 4 across · Big + 1	
Webtoon	500 × 1500 per unit	3 stacked · 5 stacked · Tall + 2	One continuous page. ↓ Longer / ↑ Shorter grow or shrink height by one unit (no page seams).

Overflow is never clipped: panels and lettering dragged fully off the page remain visible on the desk and stay part of the document.

4. Editor modes

□ Layout

- Add panels: Box, Slant, Round (14-point ellipse), Burst (20-point star). New panels drop near page center of the newest page, offset to avoid stacking.
- Tap panel → drag to move (strokes and photo move with it). Corner handles scale the whole panel, proportionally scaling ink and photo.
- Floating bar: 🖋 **shape** (per-vertex editing — drag corners, tap ◆ midpoints to add a vertex, double-tap a vertex to remove; minimum 3), 📄 **duplicate**, 🗑 **delete**. Delete/Backspace also deletes the selection.

🖋 Draw

- Tap a panel to zoom into it (focused view dims the rest of the page; "Whole page" returns). Two layers: **Ink** and **Photo**.
- Ink: Pen / Marker (2.4× width, 45% opacity) / Eraser; 7 colors; 3 brush sizes; stylus pressure scales stroke weight. Strokes clip to the panel shape.
- Photo: insert from Photos / Camera / Paste / Sample. **Fit** tab: drag to pan, Scale 20–300%, Rotate ±45°, Flip, Fill panel, Remove. **Adjust** tab: brightness / contrast / hue / saturation sliders + one-tap looks (None, Ink B&W, Pop, Vintage). All non-destructive.

💬 Letter

- Six element types dropped onto the page; drag to move, corner handle to resize, double-tap to edit text inline. Speech/Think/Shout have a draggable tail dot (Think renders trailing thought bubbles).
- Floating bar (all types): A– / A+ font size, ↺ / ↻ rotate (8° steps), 🗑 delete — plus a **type row**: font choice (Comic / Loud / Print / Serif) and Bold / Italic toggles.
- **SFX only**: an additional color row (7 swatches) recoloring the outlined display text.

Element	Rendering	Defaults
Speech	White ellipse, solid border, pointed tail	Comic, bold
Think	Dotted-border ellipse, bubble-trail tail	Comic, bold
Shout	10-point starburst, white on ink	Loud (Bangers)
Caption	Yellow box, left-aligned	Comic, bold
Narration	Skewed white box	Comic, bold italic
SFX	Display text, ink outline + drop shadow, no box	Loud, red #e0452d, –8° rotation

5. Saving & persistence

- **First Save / Save As...** opens a standard save window: name field, folder sidebar (create folders inline), and a read-only file view of the selected folder. Save As always writes a new copy.
- **Subsequent Saves** write silently to the same project. Leaving the editor (New / logo / Sign out) auto-saves unsaved work as “Comic #N” in *My Comics*.

localStorage schema

```
kapow.user      "Riley"
kapow.folders   ["My Comics", "School"]
kapow.projects  { "<id>": { name, folder, updated, pageName,
                        data: { pageKey, pageN, panels[], texts[] } } }

panel { id, pts:[[x,y]...], strokes:[{tool,color,w,op,pts}],
        photo:{src,nw,nh,x,y,pct,rot,flip,bright,contrast,hue,sat,look,cover} | null }
text   { id, kind, x, y, w, h, fs, rot, text, tail:[x,y]|null,
        font?, bold?, italic?, color? }
```

Coordinates are page units (not pixels); the canvas scales to fit. Undo history (60 steps) covers panels, texts, and page count; it is session-only.

6. Visual language



Ink #1c1a17



Accent #FFD43A (tweak: #FF7A9E / #63C3FF)



Paper #f6f3ec



Desk #e9e4d8



SFX red #e0452d

- **Type:** Nunito (UI, 600–900), Bangers (brand + loud lettering), Comic Neue (balloon text), Georgia (serif lettering option).
- **Components:** chunky 2.5–3px ink borders, 8–14px radii, hard offset shadows (2–7px, no blur), slight rotations on brand elements (–2° logo, ±1° mode tabs). Selected state = accent fill.
- **Dark mode:** theme toggle swaps surface/ink CSS variables; the comic page itself stays white.
- Ink color and hint visibility are exposed as design tweaks (accent, showHints).

7. Known limitations & open work

- **Export is a stub** — needs raster/PDF export per page.
- **Eraser paints white** instead of true transparency, so it covers photos rather than revealing them.
- **Inserted photos don't persist** across reloads (object URLs are session-scoped); needs data-URL or IndexedDB storage.
- Sign-in is identity-only; no real auth, sync, or multi-device.

- Projects screen has no thumbnails, rename, or folder browsing (folders exist only in the save window).
- Undo does not span project switches; page deletion removes off-band content by center-point test, which can surprise on elements straddling a page gap.